# Note on Integrated Agri Labs

**Introduction:**

Andhra Pradesh being an agrarian state, Government of Andhra Pradesh primarily focuses on agriculture and farmers welfare. Availability of quality inputs viz Seeds, Fertilizers & pesticides are very critical in improving the crop productivity and in reducing the cost of cultivation.

Though the state had seed (3No.), fertilizer (3 No.) and pesticide (5No.) testing laboratories currently in existence, the limited resources therein and inadequate access to farmers leaves a scope for improvement in this area. An integrated inputs testing laboratory approach at Agriculture Sub-Division level will improve more farmer engagement and improve their approachability as they are in immediate reach to farmers and also supplement the current facilities.

The Existing Quality Control Facilities (prior to July 8th) are Limited and

- Not Accessible to Farmers.
- Manual Intervention & Scope for discretion more in Quality Control.
- Quality of Agricultural Inputs being tested post Release.
- Good No of Companies is escaping Radar.

Considering this an integrated Laboratory facility for testing Seed, Fertilizer & pesticide Testing facility for their quality at Constituency level and District Level is established in a two tier model.

**Objectives of Dr YSR Agri Testing Labs:**

- Quality & certified Agri inputs are supplied to farmers.
- Pre tested Agri inputs are supplied to farmers through RBKs.
- Integrated Agri Labs will enhance the production and productivity of the Crops and ensure efficient use of resources by farmers.
- Reduce Cost of Cultivation
- Agri labs are reachable to farmers for testing any Agri input prior to usage.

**Status in establishment of YSR Agri Testing Labs:**

- Proposed to establish 147 Constituency Agri Labs & 13 District Labs along and four Regional coding centers with budget outlay of Rs 213 Crores.
- Out of 147 Constituency Agri Labs, 127 No. of Agri labs are inaugurated by Hon'ble Chief minister and are in functional stage for testing of seeds & fertilizer samples.
- Remaining 20 Constituency Labs, 9 District Labs and 4 RCCs buildings will be brought to use in coming months.

## Type of samples tested in Constituency Agri Labs:

In Agri Labs samples analyzed are
a) ACT samples
b) RBK Samples
c) Farmer samples
d) Trade samples

The Integrated Agri Labs (IALs) play a crucial role in ensuring the availability of quality inputs to farmers by covering various channels of input supply.

a. **Act Samples:**
   - MAOs and ADAs are notified and designated as input inspectors under the Seed Act 1966, Fertilizer (Control) Order 1983, and Insecticide Act 1968 to regulate Agri Inputs.
   - They visit dealer premises and draw samples and send them to Regional Coding Center's. The RCC codes the samples and sends them randomly to IALs for testing. If any sample is found to be substandard, the input inspector seizes the stocks and initiates legal action against the dealers and manufacturers.
   - IALs enforce regulatory standards by thoroughly testing input samples under relevant acts, ensuring that substandard products are identified and appropriate actions are taken to protect farmers.

b. **RBK Samples:**
   - IALs also play a critical role in the functioning of RBKs.
   - Inputs intended for sale in RBKs are pretested in IALs to ensure they meet the prescribed quality standards. Once the inputs are confirmed to be of high quality, they are displayed in digital kiosks within RBKs, allowing farmers to place their orders confidently.
   - The IALs ensures that farmers have access to reliable and superior-quality inputs through RBKs.

c. **Farmer Samples:**
   - IALs provide services to farmers free of charge, allowing them to directly submit their samples for testing.
   - Farmers can visit IALs or submit their samples through RBKs. By testing farmer samples, IALs ensure that individual farmers can verify the quality of the inputs they are using.

d. **Trade Samples:**
   - IALs also cater to the trade sector by offering their facilities to traders and Manufacturers for a nominal charge.

- This facility allows traders to have their products certified through the testing services provided by IALs, instilling confidence in the quality of their offerings.

**Types of tests conducted in Constituency Agri Labs:**

| Input | Type of tests conducted in Agri Labs | |
|---|---|---|
| | **Constituency Agri Lab** | **District Lab** |
| Seed | Physical Purity, Moisture and Germination | All tests will be conducted as per FCO, 1985 Insecticide Act, 1968 and Seed Act, 1966 & Seed (control) Order, 1983 |
| Fertilizer | Straight Fertilizers / Complexes / Mixtures of Nitrogen, phosphorus & potash<br>Zinc, Boron, Calcium, Iron | |
| Pesticide | Satellite Centre /Collection point | |

**Notification of Labs:**

- 127 No. of inaugurated constituency Agri labs are notified by the Agri & Coop,Dept GOAP.
- Official Analyst is AO (Agri Lab) and the ADAs are Supervisory officers.

**Benefits to the farmers due to Integrated Agri Labs (IALs):**

- **Accessibility:** The integrated Agri labs are established at the Agriculture Sub-Division level, making them easily accessible to farmers. This proximity allows farmers to conveniently access the labs for testing any agricultural input prior to usage. Previously, the limited number of labs and their locations posed a challenge for farmers to access quality testing facilities.

- **Quality assurance:** The integrated agri labs focus on ensuring that only quality and certified agricultural inputs are supplied to farmers. By conducting comprehensive tests on seeds, fertilizers, and pesticides, these labs help in identifying and eliminating substandard or adulterated inputs. This ensures that farmers receive inputs that meet quality standards, leading to improved crop productivity.

- **Pre-tested inputs:** The Integrated Agri Labs (IALs) collaborate with RBKs to provide farmers with pre-tested agricultural inputs. Through rigorous testing and certification, the IALs ensure that the inputs meet prescribed standards before they are made available for sale at RBKs, enabling farmers to access reliable and quality inputs. This helps farmers make informed decisions while purchasing inputs, leading to better agricultural practices.

- **Enhanced production and productivity**: The establishment of integrated agri labs aims to enhance the production and productivity of crops. By providing farmers with accurate and reliable testing services, these labs contribute to the adoption of improved farming

techniques. Farmers can optimize the use of resources based on the lab test results, leading to efficient resource management and increased crop yields.

- **Cost reduction:** The IALs play a crucial role in reducing the cost of cultivation for farmers. By ensuring the availability of quality inputs, farmers can avoid losses caused by the use of substandard or ineffective agricultural inputs. Additionally, the labs enable farmers to make informed decisions regarding input purchases, preventing unnecessary expenses on low-quality or unnecessary inputs.

- **Increased awareness:** With the establishment of IALs, farmers gain access to valuable information and knowledge related to agricultural inputs. The lab staff can provide guidance to farmers regarding the selection and proper use of inputs based on the test results. This helps in creating awareness among farmers about the importance of using quality inputs and adopting best practices in agriculture.

- **Effective Quality Control:** The IALs minimize manual intervention and provide a more objective approach to quality control. By utilizing automated analysis reports and the InSight app for monitoring quality control issues, the labs reduce the scope for discretion and ensure consistent and standardized testing procedures. This enhances the overall reliability and accuracy of the testing process.

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